

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 593

By Bowling

A RESOLUTION to designate Marlene Edwards Tidwell as "Poet Laureate Emerita of Tennessee."

WHEREAS, Marlene Edwards Tidwell is an inspirational poet whose writings capture beauty through the expression of vivid images; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Tidwell grew up on a farm in rural Tennessee, where she dreamed and dared to pen the language of her heart to paper; and

WHEREAS, her journey of writing began as a child on the front porch as she gazed upon the beautiful rural vistas that surrounded her; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Tidwell believes strongly in the power of the written word and has devoted her life to bringing the rich and wonderful experience of poetry to others; and

WHEREAS, her inspiring poems reverberate with the timeless resonance of family, nature and the fragrance of life; and

WHEREAS, she has composed articulate and moving poems that vividly capture the pride and sense of belonging we all feel as Tennesseans, including Christian, nature, and inspirational written works; and

WHEREAS, in her book, *Nature Sings*, a beautiful collection of poems, photography, and vignettes inspired by nature and its seasons, Mrs. Tidwell captures the beauty and essence of nature and a wide array of subjects through the expression of vivid images in her words; and

WHEREAS, in 2021, her poem, "My Beloved Tennessee," was named by the 112th General Assembly as an official State poem of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, that poem reads:

My thoughts wander on your path again

Captivated by the beauty of rolling hills

That rise above a road that bends,
As dusk spreads mist across the fields.
I heard the piping of the morning lay
And gazed on scenes from yesteryears,
When open come the gates of May,
And in purple ruffles the Iris appears.
Cherished memories thou doth hold,
Sweet home in Tennessee, to you I hope
To come before the winds grow cold.
Nestled in vales, quaint barns of old
Stood in wait for the gathering harvest
Scattered across autumn fields of gold,
And chapels adorned with steeples fair
Rang bells against the morning cold
Calling the pleasant and faithful there
To come and nourish thirsting souls.
Your faith has kept your pillars strong,
My heritage from days of old,
How blessed am I to call you home.
Your vaulted domes, in blue mist crowned,
Listen to babbling brooks shower chambers
Beneath, rich treasures there are found.
From afar they come to see your sights,
And hear your song, from Memphis to
Bristol, your cities shine bright.

For in distant lands your light has shown,
Oh Valiant Volunteer, you gave hope
To those you had never known.
Come to me in my dreams tonight
Oh beloved home in Tennessee,
When I wake with morning's light,
May I again be near to thee; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Tidwell's poems have been described as "an enlightened collection of one exceptional woman's ardent expressions, revelations, and impressions; deep-layered words poured from this soul's well, and the artistry within their assembly"; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Tidwell is a loving wife, mother, and grandmother and is respected and admired by her friends and community for her many talents and achievements, and is most deserving of the commendation of this body; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that in recognition and appreciation of her numerous contributions to poetry and her other laudable literary endeavors, Marlene Edwards Tidwell is hereby designated as "Poet Laureate Emerita of Tennessee," a title by which she shall henceforth be known.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.